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READINESS REPORT

Revenue Attribution Readiness

Full methodology, model comparison, and implementation guide

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About this report

This guide accompanies the Revenue Attribution Readiness Check at consult-ds.com/insights/revenue-attribution-readiness. It covers the full attribution model comparison, the data connectivity requirements, the board-confidence framework, and a sequenced implementation roadmap for each readiness level.

Attribution model comparison

Every attribution model involves trade-offs between accuracy, complexity, and data requirements. The right starting model is the one your sales and finance teams will actually trust.

Model	How credit is assigned	Strengths	Limitations
First-touch	100% to first interaction	Simple, easy to explain	Ignores full journey
Last-touch	100% to final interaction before close	Highlights conversion triggers	Biases toward bottom of funnel
Linear	Equal split across all touchpoints	Balanced, intuitive	Ignores touchpoint weighting
Time-decay	More credit to touchpoints closer to close	Rewards nurture sequences	Discounts awareness channels
W-shaped	40/20/40 to first, middle, and last touch	Reflects key journey moments	Requires agreed key touchpoints
Data-driven	Algorithmic from conversion data	Most accurate model available	Requires high conversion volume

The board-confidence framework

Board-level confidence in marketing attribution requires three conditions to be met simultaneously. Meeting two out of three still produces a disputed number.

1. Sales alignment

The head of sales has formally agreed to how marketing contribution is measured. Without this, pipeline attribution will always be challenged in revenue reviews. Sales alignment is a conversation, not a technical problem.

2. Finance reconciliation

CRM closed revenue is reconciled against the finance system monthly. The marketing contribution number must trace to the same revenue figure the CFO uses. Until it does, marketing's ROI claim sits outside the official financial record.

3. Board reporting cadence

Marketing presents attribution data in board or executive meetings on a defined schedule. A model that produces data nobody sees does not change budget decisions. The cadence creates accountability for both the number and the story behind it.

The practical test

Can sales, finance, and the board all trace the same contribution number back to a documented methodology and a reconciled revenue figure?

Implementation roadmap by readiness level

No attribution: start here

1. Implement UTM parameter standards across every paid and owned channel today. Create a naming convention document, a URL builder, and a validation checklist. This is the foundation every attribution method depends on and costs nothing but time.
2. Connect MAP and CRM bidirectionally. Validate the sync weekly. A one-way push is not an integration; it will produce attribution gaps that cannot be reconciled.
3. Deploy a first-touch or last-touch model as a baseline. Document the methodology in writing so it can be challenged and improved.
4. Start a closed-loop feedback process: sales records lead disposition in the CRM within 48 hours of handoff. This is the only way marketing learns what happened after the handoff.

Basic attribution: upgrade the model

1. Move from single-touch to a linear or W-shaped multi-touch model. The incremental data requirement is minimal if MAP-CRM integration is already in place.
2. Add offline conversions: calls, events, referrals, and partner-sourced leads. Most B2B companies have 20 to 40 percent of closed revenue that is untracked in their digital attribution model.
3. Build a monthly marketing contribution report and share it with leadership.
4. Align with finance on CAC by channel. This is the metric that converts marketing from a cost centre to a growth investment in every board conversation.

Functional attribution: reach finance alignment

1. Commission a CRM-to-finance reconciliation. Map every closed CRM opportunity to a finance invoice for the previous 12 months. The gap you find is the size of your attribution blind spot.
2. Present your attribution methodology to the CFO and reach written alignment. A documented methodology that finance has signed off on survives CMO and CRO transitions.
3. Test a data-driven model if your conversion volume supports it. You need 500 or more positive conversion events per channel per quarter.
4. Add ROAS and blended CAC to your board deck alongside pipeline contribution.

Best-in-class: extend and document

1. Explore marketing mix modelling for channels that resist click-based attribution: out-of-home, events, PR, and brand spend. MMM runs alongside click attribution.
2. Codify your attribution methodology in a formal document and version-control it. Every major revision should go through sign-off with sales and finance.
3. Build a model health dashboard tracking attribution coverage rate, UTM compliance rate, and data sync latency weekly.
4. Extend closed-loop feedback to post-sale: renewal signals, upsell patterns, and churn precursors should feed back into marketing audience and content strategy.

Author and next step

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Board-confidence checklist

Sales alignment. Finance reconciliation. Board reporting cadence. All three must be in place at the same time for attribution to influence budget and board conversations.

Ready to close the gap?

DS Consulting provides advisory plus implementation across CRM governance, marketing automation, revenue attribution, and IBM watsonx AI for regulated enterprises.

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